Social Media Marketing: Choose a Platform

Take a tour of many popular social media platforms to help you decide which are best for you. In this handout, we've listed the top platforms first, and also included comparison points for where your website fits in, and why you might want to consider a blog. Web and mobile versions are available for virtually every social media platform, and signing up is free and easy. Simply follow the sign-up instructions at the home page for the web or after downloading the mobile app version.

Platform		Description	Metrics	Useful Websites
	Facebook	This is your news channel for "family and friends." You post the human side of your business here – but keep it classy at the same time. Update at least weekly.	Fans, likes, reactions, comments, post views, impressions, and unsubscribes.	Create a Facebook page
	Instagram	Instagram is an image-based platform that is owned by Facebook, so the two platforms work very well together. This is a place to tell very short stories or capture moments with images or short video.	Engagements, click-throughs, hashtag usage, and followers.	How do I create an Instagram account?
	Twitter	Twitter provides you an easy way to stay in front of your audience. It shows what you are following, what you are doing, and – to the extent that it is part of your company voice – what you care about. Posts are no more than 140 characters. Send "Tweets" at least 4-5 times per week, more during events.	Direct Messages, likes, followers, mentions, replies, retweets.	How to use Twitter: Critical Tips for New Users
	Pinterest	An excellent way to showcase items that are very visual, and to link out to things of interest to you and your brand that do not require significant writing skills for you to be successful. Easy to update, and should be updated very frequently, even multiple times per day.	Site metrics, most re-pinned and most clicked.	A Guide to Pinterest

	LinkedIn	This is a very formal presentation of your organization. Reports, posts, and connections essentially follow the official public face you want your company to present.	Views, impressions, clicks, engagements, and follower demographics.	How to Use LinkedIn as a Marketing Tool
	YouTube	YouTube is a video hosting service. Videos are generally under 10 minutes, and are perfect for a company that does a lot of training or demonstrations, as it is a great place to showcase talent in those areas. The real value in YouTube comes from a steady flow of new content.	View, watch time, engagement, and audience retention metrics.	3 Tips for Effective YouTube Marketing
	Tumblr	The wild west of social media. Many Tumblr sites are fairly edgy, even adult in themes.	Provided by a third party for a fee.	The Beginner's Guide to Tumblr
	Snapchat	The younger, more fun-centered version of Instagram. It has the advantage of allowing your posts to have a silly fun character, then disappear after 10 seconds.	Views, story completions, completion rates, fallout rates, screenshots taken.	Snapchat Support
	Blogs	Blogs support your social media efforts by providing more context and depth to your messages. Link from your social posts to articles that give your customers additional information on the topic. While posts do not need to be lengthy, they should be frequent – ideally once a week – and they take time and effort to be successful.	Views, likes, and comments. Sites will vary.	Top 10 Best Free Blog Platforms
	Your Website	Every company needs a website, but as it is primarily a one-way communication, it is not considered social media. This is your formal face to the world. It provides official company information, and official news, aimed at a public audience. Update your website at least once a month and review it carefully for outdated info.	Views, likes, and comments. Sites will vary.	5 Benefits of Having a Website for Your Small Business